

Empowerly

Comprehensive Product Management & Requirements Document (PRD)



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Product Owner: Ishaan Verma

1. Executive Summary

Empowerly is a unified, AI-native Employee Management System designed to consolidate fragmented Human Resources (HR) operations into a single, intuitive, and intelligent platform.

In today's fast-paced corporate environment, HR teams are overwhelmed by administrative tasks scattered across multiple disjointed systems, while employees suffer from poor engagement and opaque processes.

Empowerly addresses these inefficiencies by bringing together core HR functions—Attendance, Leave, Payroll, and Performance Reviews—and supercharging them with cutting-edge AI (Google Gemini 2.0).

By integrating real-time collaboration tools (WebRTC, WebSockets) and enterprise-grade security within a modern UI, Empowerly transforms HR from an administrative burden into a strategic asset.

2. Problem Space & Market Analysis

2.1 The Core Problem

1. **"Tool Fatigue" & Data Silos:** Organizations use an average of 4-6 different applications for HR (one for attendance, another for payroll, Slack/Teams for chat, Zoom for video, a separate portal for leaves). This creates massive data silos and operational overhead.
2. **Administrative Bottlenecks:** Payroll calculations, leave approvals, and answering routine HR policy questions take up to 40% of an HR professional's week.
3. **Low Employee Engagement:** Traditional HR portals are transactional. They lack elements that foster motivation, continuous learning, and peer-to-peer recognition.
4. **Lack of Actionable Insights:** Without unified data, HR cannot predict employee churn, identify skill gaps, or measure true performance trends.

2.2 Competitive Analysis (SWOT)

Competitors: Workday, BambooHR, Zoho People

Strengths (Empowerly): Deep AI integration native to the platform (Chatbot, Skill matching, AI motivation); unified collaboration (video/chat built-in); modern tech stack ensuring high speed and low latency.

Weaknesses: Being a new entrant, lacks the deep, decade-long enterprise integrations and legacy ERP connections of a Workday.

Opportunities: The mid-market (100-1000 employees) is severely underserved by affordable, AI-first HR tools. High demand for consolidation to reduce software subscription costs.

Threats: Fast-moving AI features being replicated by legacy players; stringent data privacy regulations (GDPR/CCPA) when processing employee data with AI.

3. Target Audience & Deep Personas

Persona 1: "Elena" - The Core Employee Core User

Demographics: 25-35 years old, Software Engineer / Marketing Specialist.

Technical Proficiency: High. Expects modern, consumer-grade UX (like Netflix or Slack).

Jobs To Be Done (JTBD): "When I need to take a day off, I want to apply in 10 seconds and know my balance instantly, so I can plan my life without waiting days for HR to reply."

Pain Points: Digging through PDF handbooks for policies; feeling disconnected from remote teammates.

Empowerly Solution: 1-click check-in, 24/7 AI Chatbot for instant policy answers, Motivation Wall to celebrate wins, WebRTC for instant peer syncs.

Persona 2: "Harry" - The HR Administrator Administrator

Demographics: 30-45 years old, HR Manager / People Ops.

Technical Proficiency: Medium. Prefers dashboards, clear workflows, and automated reporting.

Jobs To Be Done (JTBD): "When the month ends, I want to process payroll flawlessly in a few clicks, so I ensure everyone gets paid accurately and on time without manual spreadsheet errors."

Pain Points: Answering the same policy questions repeatedly; manually cross-referencing attendance with leave to calculate payroll.

Empowerly Solution: Automated payroll pipeline, AI chatbot deflecting 70% of routine questions, unified dashboard for pending approvals.

Persona 3: "Alex" - The IT / System Admin Security & System

Demographics: 35-50 years old, Head of IT / InfoSec.

Technical Proficiency: Expert.

Jobs To Be Done (JTBD): "When onboarding a new tool, I need absolute assurance of data security and access control, so our company complies with data protection laws."

Pain Points: Shadow IT, lack of audit logs, unauthorized access.

Empowerly Solution: JWT authentication, strict Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), real-time session tracking, anomaly detection alerts.

4. Product Scope & Detailed Requirements

Epic 1: Core HR & Identity Management

Objective: Establish a secure foundation for employee data and daily tracking.

Feature 1.1: Authentication & Onboarding

User Story: As an Admin, I want to invite users via email so they can securely set up their accounts using OTP.

Acceptance Criteria: OTP expires in 5 minutes; JWT token is issued upon successful login; user role (EMPLOYEE, HR, ADMIN) is strictly enforced.

Feature 1.2: Attendance Tracking

User Story: As an Employee, I want to click a single button to check in/out, so my hours are accurately logged.

Acceptance Criteria: System captures exact timestamp; prevents double check-ins; auto-checkouts at midnight if left open.

Feature 1.3: Leave Management

User Story: As an HR Admin, I want to see a unified queue of leave requests so I can approve/reject them with remarks.

Acceptance Criteria: Employee balances automatically update upon approval; status changes trigger real-time notifications.

Epic 2: Payroll & Performance Automation

Objective: Automate financial and evaluation workflows.

Feature 2.1: Automated Payroll Generation

User Story: As HR, I want the system to auto-calculate monthly salary based on base pay, attendance, and approved leaves.

Acceptance Criteria: Accurate calculation of deductions; bulk generation of PDF payslips (via iText7); secure storage of payroll history.

Feature 2.2: Performance Review Cycles

User Story: As an Employee, I want to submit my self-evaluation on a 1-5 scale so my manager can review it.

Acceptance Criteria: Configurable deadlines; dual-input (Self + HR); historical tracking of previous cycles.

Epic 3: AI Intelligence Engine (Gemini 2.0 Integration)

Objective: Reduce manual overhead and provide personalized experiences using LLMs.

Feature 3.1: AI HR Support Chatbot

User Story: As an Employee, I want to ask the bot "What is the maternity leave policy?" and get an instant, accurate answer based on company documents.

Acceptance Criteria: Bot maintains context of the user's role; response time < 2 seconds; graceful fallback if it doesn't know the answer.

Feature 3.2: Skill Recommendations

User Story: As an Employee, I want to receive personalized course recommendations based on my current department and performance reviews.

Acceptance Criteria: AI analyzes user profile and returns structured JSON with 3-5 relevant skills and resources.

Feature 3.3: AI Performance Insights

User Story: As HR, I want the AI to summarize an employee's annual performance based on past reviews to help me write the final appraisal.

Epic 4: Collaboration & Engagement

Objective: Build a connected culture for remote/hybrid teams.

Feature 4.1: Internal Motivation Wall

User Story: As an Employee, I want to post a "Kudos" message to a teammate so the whole company can see their hard work.

Acceptance Criteria: Categorized posts (Success, Ideas, Announcements); like/comment functionality.

Feature 4.2: WebRTC Video Meetings & WebSocket Chat

User Story: As an Employee, I want to instantly jump into a video call with a colleague without leaving the HR portal.

Acceptance Criteria: Low-latency P2P video connection; persistent chat history with read receipts.

5. User Journeys & Workflow Diagrams

5.1 The Payroll Lifecycle Journey

- 1 **Setup:** Admin defines Salary Structures for employees (Base, Allowances, Tax Brackets).
- 2 **Cycle Initiation:** At month-end, HR creates a "December 2024 Payroll Cycle".
- 3 **Data Aggregation:** The backend aggregates Attendance Logs (Total Hours) and Leave Logs (Unpaid leaves taken).
- 4 **Processing:** System calculates final Net Pay.
- 5 **Approval:** HR reviews the drafted batch and submits it to Admin. Admin clicks "Approve".
- 6 **Distribution:** System generates PDF payslips and alerts Employees. Employees download securely from their dashboard.

5.2 The AI Chatbot Interaction Flow

- 1 **Trigger:** Employee opens the Chatbot widget.
- 2 **Input:** Asks a natural language query ("Can I carry forward my Earned Leaves?").
- 3 **Context Enrichment:** Backend attaches user's profile data (Department: Sales, Role: Employee) to the prompt.
- 4 **LLM Processing:** Request sent to Google Gemini 2.0 Flash via Spring WebFlux.
- 5 **Output:** Formatted markdown response is streamed back to the frontend UI.

6. Go-To-Market (GTM) Strategy & Monetization

6.1 Pricing Strategy (SaaS B2B Model)

- **Starter Tier (Free up to 10 users):** Basic attendance, leave, and motivation wall. Designed for product-led growth (PLG) and viral startup adoption.
- **Pro Tier (\$5/user/month):** Adds Automated Payroll, Performance Reviews, and basic Chat.
- **Enterprise Tier (\$12/user/month):** Unlocks all AI features (HR Chatbot, Skill Recommendations), WebRTC Video Meetings, Custom API access, and advanced Security monitoring.

6.2 Acquisition Channels

1. **Product-Led Growth (PLG):** Free starter tier encourages startups to adopt Empowerly early. As they grow, they naturally upgrade to Pro/Enterprise.
2. **Content Marketing:** Publishing whitepapers on "The ROI of AI in HR" and "Reducing Tool Fatigue."
3. **Direct Sales (Outbound):** Targeting HR Directors at companies with 200-500 employees using fragmented tools.

7. Objectives and Key Results (OKRs)

Objective 1: Drive Unprecedented User Adoption and Engagement

- **Key Result 1:** Achieve an 85% Daily Active User (DAU) to Monthly Active User (MAU) ratio within 3 months of launch.
- **Key Result 2:** See an average of 3 posts per user per month on the Motivation Wall.
- **Key Result 3:** Have 50% of 1-on-1 meetings conducted via Empowerly's native WebRTC instead of external tools.

Objective 2: Maximize HR Operational Efficiency

- **Key Result 1:** Reduce time spent on monthly payroll processing by 70% (from an average of 3 days to <1 day).
- **Key Result 2:** Deflect 60% of Tier-1 HR policy questions to the AI Chatbot.
- **Key Result 3:** Achieve a 95% on-time completion rate for Performance Review cycles.

Objective 3: Maintain Enterprise-Grade Reliability and Security

- **Key Result 1:** Maintain 99.99% system uptime across all core modules.
- **Key Result 2:** Achieve <200ms API response times at the 95th percentile.
- **Key Result 3:** Zero critical security vulnerabilities in quarterly penetration tests.

8. Risk Management & Mitigation

Risk Category	Specific Risk	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation Strategy
Technical	WebRTC connection failures on corporate firewalls (STUN/TURN issues).	High	Medium	Implement robust fallback TURN servers (e.g., Twilio) to guarantee connection traversal.
Security	PII Data Breach (Employee salaries, reviews).	Critical	Low	Strict RBAC; Encrypt MongoDB at rest; masking sensitive data in backend logs; routine security audits.
AI Reliability	AI Chatbot providing "hallucinated" or incorrect policy answers.	High	Medium	Strict prompt engineering grounding the LLM only to internal documents. Implement a "Talk to Human HR" fallback button.
Adoption	Employees resist using a new system, preferring old habits.	Medium	Medium	Invest heavily in intuitive UI/UX (Framer motion, clean design); mandate use for essential tasks (Payroll/Leave).

9. Roadmap & Future Scope

Phase 1: MVP & Core Stability (Q1 - Current)

- Seamless Authentication & RBAC.
- Core modules: Attendance, Leave, Payroll.
- AI HR Chatbot and Motivation Wall.
- WebRTC Video and WebSocket Chat.

Phase 2: Analytics & Integrations (Q2)

- **Advanced Predictive Analytics:** Dashboards predicting flight risk (attrition) and burnout based on attendance anomalies and leave patterns.
- **Calendar Integrations:** Bi-directional sync with Google Workspace and Microsoft 365.
- **Mobile Applications:** Launch native iOS and Android apps using React Native.

Phase 3: Enterprise Scale & Customization (Q3)

- **No-Code Workflow Builder:** Allow HR to drag-and-drop custom approval hierarchies.
- **Global Compliance Engine:** Automated tax rules for payroll across multiple countries/states.
- **Open API Platform:** Public APIs for enterprises to connect Empowerly to legacy ERPs (e.g., SAP, Oracle).

End of Document. Empowerly is uniquely positioned to disrupt the mid-market HR tech space by combining essential operational tools with next-generation AI and communication capabilities.